

Functional programming

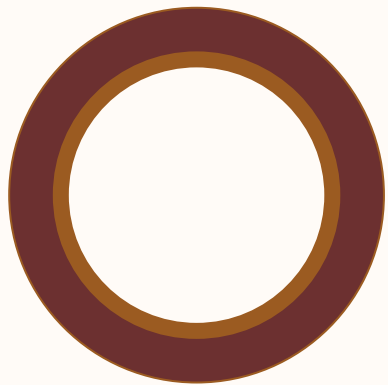
CS 22B, Spring 2026

Module 03: Function

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AGENDA

- Review functions
- Functional Programming
 - Functional Programming
 - Side effect
 - Pure function
 - Higher-order functions
 - Lambda function



Chapter 9: Functions

The Quick Python Book



Syntax for defining a function

04

define **name of the function** **parameter(s)**
pass into function

```
def get_at_content (dna):  
    '''Function computes the proportion of A's and T's in dna.  
    Args:  
        dna: string param  
    Returns:  
        at_content: type(float) between 0 and 1, inclusively  
    '''  
    # length of arg  
    length = len(dna)  
    a_count = dna.count('A')  
    t_count = dna.count('T')  
    at_content = (a_count + t_count) / length  
    return at_content
```

docstring

Obtain value by printing

get_at_content.__doc__

return will create the outputs of the function

Function parameter options

05

- You can specify the specific type of an argument

```
def get_at_content(dna:str):  
    '''Function computes the proportion of A's and T's in dna.  
    Args:  
        dna: string param  
    Returns:  
        at_content: type(float) between 0 and 1, inclusively  
    '''  
    length = len(dna)  
    a_count = dna.count('A')  
    t_count = dna.count('T')  
    at_content = (a_count + t_count) / length  
    return at_content
```

Function parameter options

- You can specify the specific type of an argument
- You can specify if you want the returned object to be of a specific type

```
def get_at_content(dna:str) -> int:
    '''Function computes the proportion of A's and T's in dna.
    Args:
        dna: string param
    Returns:
        at_content: type(float) between 0 and 1, inclusively
    '''
    length = len(dna)
    a_count = dna.count('A')
    t_count = dna.count('T')
    at_content = (a_count + t_count) / length
    return at_content
```

Question

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```
print("AT content is " + get_at_content("ATGACTGGACCA"))
```

If `get_at_content` already defined what will be the output to the above statement?

- ☐ A) AT content is 0.5
- ☐ B) AT content is
- ☐ C) Nothing will be printed
- ☒ D) Error

Assign values to arguments in functions

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```
def get_at_content(dna, sig_fig=2):  
    '''Function computes the proportion of A's and T's in dna.  
    Args:  
        dna: string param  
    Returns:  
        at_content: type(float) between 0 and 1, inclusively  
    '''  
    length = len(dna)  
    a_count = dna.count('A')  
    t_count = dna.count('T')  
    at_content = (a_count + t_count) / length  
    return round(at_content)
```

```
>>> dna = "ATGACTGGACCA"  
>>> print("AT content is " + str(get_at_content sig_fig=3, dna=dna,)))  
                                     keyword passing
```


Variable number of arguments; *

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```
def varArg(x, *y):  
    '''Example to show variable arguments'''  
    print(x)  
    print(y)  
    print(type(y))  
  
varArg(1)  
varArg(1, 2)  
varArg(1, 2, 3, 4)
```

* causes all excess non-keyword arguments to be collected and assigned as **tuple**

Variable number of arguments; **

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```
def varArg(x, **y):  
    '''Example to show variable arguments'''  
    print(x)  
    print(y)  
    print(type(y))  
    print(y.keys())  
    print(y.values())
```

} ** causes all excess keyword arguments to be collected and assigned as **dictionary**

What about...

```
varArg(1, 2, a=3, b=4)
```

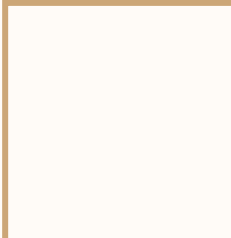
```
varArg(x=1)  
varArg(1)  
varArg(1, z=2)  
varArg(1, a=2, b=3, c=4)
```

Mixed argument-passing techniques

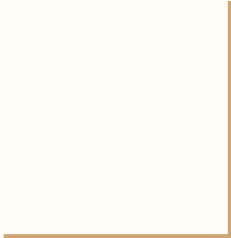
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It is possible to use all the argument-passing features of Python functions at the same time with the following rules:

1. Positional arguments come first
2. then named arguments
3. followed by indefinite positional arguments with a single *
4. and last of all the indefinite keyword argument with **



Functional programming



What is Functional Python Programming?

Functional programming is a style where:

- Functions do NOT change outside variables
- Functions always return the same output for the same input
- Avoid modifying data (no hidden state changes)

Procedural vs functional programming

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Procedural

The variable changes inside the for loop

```
x = 0
for i in range(10):
    x = x + i
print(x)
```

x keeps changing (mutable state)

Functional

Does not use state.

```
x = sum(range(10))
print(x)
```

x does not change (not mutable)
Use built-in function (eg., sum())
Has no side effect

Functional programming minimizes or isolate side effects

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Function with side effect

The original variable changes

```
def add_items(lst):  
    lst.append("A")  
    return lst
```

```
my_list = [1, 2, 3]  
add_items(my_list)  
print(my_list)
```

Original list is changed

```
[1, 2, 3, 'A']
```

Pure function

The original variable remains unchanged

```
def add_items(lst):  
    return lst + ["A"]
```

```
my_list = [1, 2, 3]  
new_list = add_items(my_list)  
  
print(my_list)  
print(new_list)
```

Class exercise

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CL 7.1

Are functions f1 and f2 pure?

```
def f1(x):  
    print(x)  
    return x * 2  
  
def f2(x):  
    return x * 2
```

Technically, printing changes a program output and thus is a side effect.

A function is NOT pure if:

- Prints, reads, or writes a file
- Modifies a global variable
- Changes a variable passed into it
- Dependent on external variables

Function should be Reproducible

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A function should always return the same value if given the same input. The code below breaks the rule because the behavior of the function changes depending on the value of `to_add` at the time that it's called.

```
def my_function(x):  
    return(x + to_add)
```

```
>>>to_add =['a', 'b', 'c']  
>>>x = [1,2,3]  
>>>print(my_function(x))  
[1, 2, 3, 'a', 'b', 'c']  
>>>to_add =['x', 'y', 'z']  
>>>print(my_function(x))  
[1, 2, 3, 'x', 'y', 'z']
```

Class exercise

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CL 7.2

How do these two functions differ in terms of mutability?

```
lsti = [1, 2, 3]
def my_function1(i):
    i.extend(['a', 'b', 'c'])
    return(i)
lst = my_function1(lsti)
```

Function1 modifies the input, `lsti`

```
def my_function2(i):
    return(i + ['a', 'b', 'c'])
```

Function2 is immutable and *functional*

Class exercise

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CL 7.3

Change this to make it functional

```
total = 0
for i in range(1, 11):
    total += i*i
print(total)
```

2/17: Start here next class

Mutable Objects as Arguments

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Passing a mutable objects as an argument in a function allows the function to modify the original object in place and these changes are reflected outside the function.

```
def f(n, list1, list2):  
    list1.append(3)  
    list2 = [4, 5, 6]  
    n = n + 1
```

```
x = 5  
y = [1, 2]  
z = [4, 5]  
f(x, y, z)
```

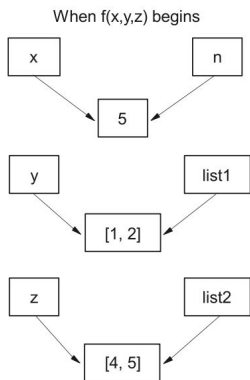


Figure 9.1 At the beginning of function $f()$, both the initial variables and the function parameters refer to the same objects.

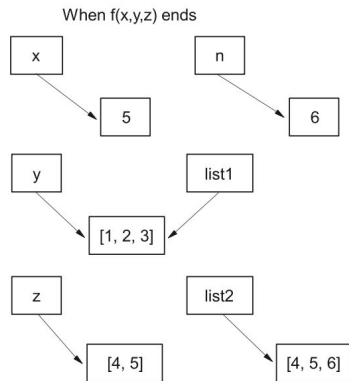


Figure 9.2 At the end of function $f()$, y ($list1$ inside the function) has been changed internally, whereas n and $list2$ refer to different objects.

Modification of y is a “side effect”

Side effect of function

If the function has side effects, then we have no way of knowing what/why the value of `x` is after the function call without going and looking at the code. Functional programming is used so that data is immutable and pure functions ensure predictability and reusability!

```
x = [1, 4, 9]
some_function(x)  ← What is the value of x now?
```

```
def some_function(input):
    some_other_function(input) ← What if in some_function()
    another_function(input)      we find it calls other
    yet_another_function(input)  functions?
```

Recursion method to make code function

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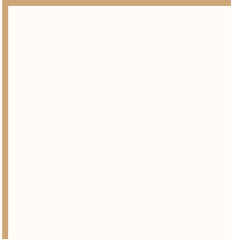
Recursive has no mutable variables and uses function calls instead of loops.

```
from functools import reduce
result = reduce(lambda acc, x: acc + x, range(10))
```

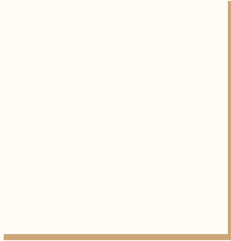
```
def sum_numbers(x):
    if x == 0:
        return 0
    return x + sum_numbers(x - 1)
print(sum_numbers(9))
```

Base case:
Condition stops recursion when base case met

Recursive case:
Call function with (x-1)



Higher Order Functions



Higher order function

There are many common programming tasks that can be made easier using higher order functions. A higher-order function is a function that either:

- Takes another function as an argument (input), OR
- Returns a function as a result

This allows for function composition, reusability, and cleaner code. Examples of built-in order functions include:

- `map(function, iterable)` and `apply()`
- `filter(function, iterable)`
- `sorted(iterable, key=function)`

What is `map()` and `apply()`?

Python functions used to transform or manipulate data, especially when working with pandas (we will introduce this later in the semester).

- They are commonly used to apply a function to elements within a sequence (like lists or DataFrame columns)
- **`map()`** used to apply a function to each element of a sequence (list, pandas Series)
- `apply()` used on both Series and DataFrames. Apply functions element-wise, row-wise, or column-wise.

(We will come back to `apply()`)

More on map(function, iterable)

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`map(function, iterable)` returns a map object (an iterable like a list) of the results after applying the given function to each item of a given iterable (list, pandas Series, etc.).

`map()` takes two arguments:

1. **function**: The name of the transformation function to apply
2. **iterable**: The sequence (e.g., list, Series) you want to iterate over.

Class exercise

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```
def square(x):  
    return x ** 2  
numbers = [1, 2, 3, 4]  
squared_numbers = list(map(square, numbers))  
print(squared_numbers)
```

CL 7.4

When we use `map()` on a list:

- *What is the expected output of `squared_numbers`?*
- *What will numbers returned after mapping?*

map() with lambda function

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The transformation functions that we pass to `map()` are often very short, it's quite common to use lambda functions to do the job instead.

lambda function: A lambda function can take any number of arguments, but can only have one expression

```
lambda arguments: expression
```

- **arguments:** The parameters you pass to the lambda function
- **expression:** A single expression whose result is automatically returned

Class exercise

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```
stringlist = ["and", "ant", "air", "anything"]  
  
bstring = list(map(lambda x:x.replace("a", "B"),stringlist))  
print(bstring)
```

CL 7.5

When we use map() and lambda function:

- *What is the expected output?*

apply() on Series and DataFrame

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`apply()` used on both Series and DataFrames. Apply functions element-wise, row-wise, or column-wise.

Syntax for Series:

`Series.apply(function)`

Syntax for DataFrame: (we will revisit this later)

`DataFrame.apply(function, axis=0 or 1)`, where:

- `axis=0`: Apply function to each `column` (default)
- `axis=1`: Apply function to each `row`

filter(function, iterable) is for selecting elements from a list that satisfy some condition and returns a *filter object* (an iterable)

filter() takes two arguments:

1. The **name of a function** that takes a single element as its argument and returns a Boolean value (True or False) to indicate whether or not that element should be included in the result list
2. The **name of the original list**

Using `filter()` function to filter elements based on a condition. With lambda, apply a condition

```
numbers = [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6]
even_numbers = list(filter(lambda x: x % 2 == 0, numbers))
print(even_numbers)
```


Class exercise

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Given a list of numbers, remove any numbers whose square are less than 100.

```
num_input= [1, 4, 5, 20, 15, 70, 15, 6, 7, 70]
```

```
def greater100(num):  
    return num ** 2 >= 100
```

CL 7.6

Work with a partner and write your own code with at least 1 higher order function.

`sorted()` is for sorting lists in alphabetical or numerical order and it returns a new list

- It creates a sorted copy of the list, which is more compatible with the functional programming ideas of avoiding state and mutability.
 - Returns a new list while the original list is unchanged
- `sorted()` method is more flexible as it's not restricted to lists – we can call `sorted` on any iterable data type (strings, files, etc).
- `sorted()` can also sort in the reverse order.

sorted() function

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Using sorted() function to sort a list of tuples by the second element

```
my_list = [4, 1, 9, 2, 4]
sorted_list = sorted(my_list)
print(sorted_list)
```

```
numbers = [5, 2, 9, 1, 7]
sorted_numbers_desc = sorted(numbers, reverse=True)
print(sorted_numbers_desc)
```

sorted() function with keys

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sorted() function can be used to sort in a different order – for example, by length.

To do this, we supply sorted() with a **key function**. The key function must take a single argument, and return the value that we want to sort on.

```
data = [("james", 30), ("mai", 20), ("ann", 19)]  
sorted_data = sorted(data, key=lambda x: x[1])
```

Class exercise

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```
vegfruit = [(1, "zuchinni"), (3, "carrot"), (2, "apple"),  
(5, "orange"), (4, "banana")]
```

CL 7.7

Sort this list of tuples by second element in reverse order

Class exercise

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CL 7.6

Rewrite this procedurally written code into functional style using `map()`, `lambda`, `sum()`

```
total = 0
for i in range(1, 21):
    if i % 2 == 0:
        total += i**2
    else:
        total += i**3

print(total)
```